

D757

Special Education Curriculum

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A third grader has average scores in math and oral language but reads far below grade level despite strong core instruction and a Tier 2 reading group. His vision and hearing are normal. He loves dinosaurs and his class has a class pet hamster. Which pattern fits best?

- A. Lack of instruction.
- B. A lack of interest in reading about dinosaurs.
- C. A possible specific learning disability in reading.
- D. An intellectual disability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads far below grade level. Which fact would most rule out a specific learning disability as the primary cause?

- A. She dislikes reading.
- B. She is in fourth grade.
- C. She has average math skills.
- D. She missed most of two school years and received little reading instruction.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 9-year-old has a full-scale IQ of 66. She dresses herself, makes simple purchases, follows the bus routine, and plays well with peers, all at age-expected levels. She has two older brothers and takes ballet. Which conclusion is best?

- A. IQ scores never matter for this decision.
- B. She does not meet intellectual disability criteria without adaptive behavior deficits; more assessment may be needed.
- C. She has an intellectual disability because her IQ is below 70.
- D. She has an intellectual disability because she depends on her brothers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

On a test with mean 100 and SD 15, about what score marks 'significantly below average' intellectual functioning?

- A.** About 70
- B.** About 130
- C.** About 50
- D.** About 85

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A sixth grader with autism reads above grade level and loves train schedules. In group work, he talks at length about trains and does not notice when peers lose interest. The school's new library opened last month. Which feature of autism is most visible here?

- A.** A lack of language.
- B.** A preference for the new library.
- C.** An intellectual disability.
- D.** Differences in social communication, such as reading peers' interest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A kindergarten teacher in a school with a new playground says, "Say 'cat.' Now say it without the /k/." Students say 'at.' The teacher has a bright rug with letters on it. What skill is this?

- A.** Reading fluency.
- B.** Phonics.
- C.** Phonemic awareness (phoneme deletion).
- D.** Letter recognition, because of the letter rug.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task is phonics, not phonemic awareness?

- A.** Rhyming 'cat' and 'hat' aloud.
- B.** Reading the written word 'ship' by blending /sh/ /i/ /p/.
- C.** Saying 'map' with /t/ instead of /p/.
- D.** Clapping syllables in 'butterfly.'

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A small rural district has only one special education classroom, a resource room. A student with significant medical needs requires home instruction for several months. The district recently built a new gym. What must the district do?

- A. Provide home instruction, since the continuum must be available based on need.
- B. Wait until the student can return.
- C. Place the student in the resource room, since that is all it has.
- D. Use the new gym for instruction.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which placement is the least restrictive on the continuum?

- A. Separate special school.
- B. Hospital instruction.
- C. General education class with consultation and supports.
- D. Separate special education class all day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A teacher wants students with memory weaknesses to learn that 'ranidae' is the frog family. The class uses a new science textbook, and the lesson is on a Monday. Which strategy is a keyword mnemonic?

- A. Link 'ranidae' to 'rainy day' and picture frogs jumping in the rain.
- B. Read the textbook chapter twice.
- C. Repeat 'ranidae means frogs' ten times.
- D. Spell the word aloud.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A capable seventh grader with ADHD often forgets steps in science labs and loses handouts. He is on the swim team and likes robotics. Which support fits best?

- A. Take off points each time he loses a handout.
- B. Teach him to use a step checklist and a labeled folder, then fade prompts as he succeeds.
- C. Give him a checklist forever without fading.
- D. Assign him to the robotics club.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A fifth grader solves advanced logic puzzles and gives sophisticated answers in class discussions but writes only one or two sentences, with many spelling errors. He has a younger sister and is in the chess club. What should the team consider?

- A.** That chess club is taking his writing time.
- B.** That he is lazy about writing.
- C.** That he cannot have a disability since he is gifted.
- D.** That he may be twice-exceptional and need both advanced work and writing supports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A third grader has average scores in math and oral language but reads far below grade level despite strong core instruction and a Tier 2 reading group. His vision and hearing are normal. ~~He loves dinosaurs and his class has a class pet hamster.~~ Which pattern fits best?

Target word: identify SLD pattern **Decides:** Unexpected underachievement with adequate instruction ruled out as cause.

A	Dropped element	Drops the strong core and Tier 2 instruction.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
C	Correct	Unexpected, specific difficulty after adequate instruction.
D	Confusion set	Average scores in other areas argue against it.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A student reads far below grade level. Which fact would most rule out a specific learning disability as the primary cause?

Target word: reverse: exclusion factor **Decides:** SLD excludes lack of appropriate instruction.

A	Adjacent category	Motivation alone does not exclude SLD.
B	Wrong stem number	Grade level does not decide eligibility.
C	Inverted operation	Average skills elsewhere support SLD.
D	Correct	Lack of instruction must be ruled out for SLD.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A 9-year-old has a full-scale IQ of 66. She dresses herself, makes simple purchases, follows the bus routine, and plays well with peers, all at age-expected levels. ~~She has two older brothers and takes ballet.~~ Which conclusion is best?

Target word: ID criteria **Decides:** Adaptive behavior is typical.

A	Absolute language	Intellectual functioning is one required part.
B	Correct	ID requires both low IQ and adaptive deficits.
C	Dropped element	Drops the adaptive behavior requirement.
D	Camouflage	Uses the brothers; the stem says her skills are age-expected.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

On a test with mean 100 and SD 15, about what score marks 'significantly below average' intellectual functioning?

Target word: solve for cutoff **Decides:** About 2 SD below the mean.

A	Correct	$100 - 2 \times 15 = 70.$
B	Inverted operation	2 SD above.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses a number not tied to 2 SD.
D	Dropped element	Only 1 SD below.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A sixth grader with autism reads above grade level and loves train schedules. In group work, he talks at length about trains and does not notice when peers lose interest. ~~The school's new library opened last month.~~ Which feature of autism is most visible here?

Target word: identify core feature **Decides:** Difficulty with back-and-forth social exchange.

A	Inverted operation	He speaks at length.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
C	Confusion set	He reads above grade level.
D	Correct	Core social communication difference.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A kindergarten teacher ~~in a school with a new playground~~ says, "Say 'cat.' Now say it without the /k/." Students say 'at.' ~~The teacher has a bright rug with letters on it.~~ What skill is this?

Target word: classify the task **Decides:** Spoken sounds only; no print.

A	Adjacent category	Fluency is reading text accurately and smoothly.
B	Confusion set	Phonics links sounds to letters.
C	Correct	Manipulates sounds without letters.
D	Camouflage	The rug is not used in the task.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which task is phonics, not phonemic awareness?

Target word: reverse: find the print task **Decides:** Letters are involved.

A	Inverted operation	Oral sound play, not print.
B	Correct	Links sounds to print.
C	Confusion set	Phoneme substitution; oral only.
D	Adjacent category	Phonological awareness; no print.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A small rural district has only one special education classroom, a resource room. A student with significant medical needs requires home instruction for several months. ~~The district recently built a new gym.~~ What must the district do?

Target word: continuum duty **Decides:** Placement must meet individual need.

A	Correct	Districts must make the continuum available.
B	Dropped element	Drops services during the absence.
C	Adjacent category	Availability does not decide placement.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant.

9. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Which placement is the least restrictive on the continuum?

Target word: reverse: order the continuum **Decides:** Most time with nondisabled peers.

A	Confusion set	Among the most restrictive.
B	Adjacent category	Very restrictive, used for medical need.
C	Correct	Most time with nondisabled peers.
D	Inverted operation	More restrictive.

10. Answer A Concept 6

A teacher wants students with memory weaknesses to learn that ‘ranidae’ is the frog family. ~~The class uses a new science textbook, and the lesson is on a Monday.~~ Which strategy is a keyword mnemonic?

Target word: identify keyword method **Decides:** Sound-alike word plus interactive image.

A	Correct	Sound-alike keyword plus image.
B	Camouflage	Uses the textbook; not a mnemonic.
C	Confusion set	Rote rehearsal.
D	Dropped element	Drops the link to meaning.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A capable seventh grader with ADHD often forgets steps in science labs and loses handouts. ~~He is on the swim team and likes robotics.~~ Which support fits best?

Target word: executive function support **Decides:** Missing steps and lost materials.

A	Inverted operation	Consequences alone do not build skills.
B	Correct	Taught, then faded, external supports.
C	Absolute language	Supports should fade as independence grows.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A fifth grader solves advanced logic puzzles and gives sophisticated answers in class discussions but writes only one or two sentences, with many spelling errors. ~~He has a younger sister and is in the chess club.~~ What should the team consider?

Target word: recognize 2e **Decides:** Uneven profile: high reasoning, weak writing.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
B	Adjacent category	Misattributes a possible disability.
C	Inverted operation	Giftedness does not rule out disability.
D	Correct	Both strengths and a disability can coexist.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Specific learning disability characteristics	An SLD is a disorder in basic psychological processes affecting reading, writing, or math, not primarily caused by intellectual disability, sensory loss, emotional disturbance, or lack of instruction.	Labeling any low achiever SLD, including students who never had adequate instruction.	Unexpected underachievement in one area with typical ability elsewhere.
2	Intellectual disability criteria	Intellectual disability requires both significantly below-average intellectual functioning (about 2 SD below the mean) and deficits in adaptive behavior, beginning in the developmental period.	Deciding on IQ score alone.	A low IQ score but typical everyday living skills, or the reverse.
3	Core features of autism	Autism involves persistent differences in social communication and interaction plus restricted, repetitive behaviors or interests, including sensory differences.	Assuming autism always includes intellectual disability or lack of language.	A student with strong academics but trouble with back-and-forth social exchange.
4	Phonemic awareness vs. phonics	Phonemic awareness is hearing and manipulating sounds in spoken words (no print); phonics links sounds to letters in print.	Calling a letter-sound task phonemic awareness.	Whether letters or print are involved in the task.
5	Continuum of alternative placements	Districts must offer a range from general education with supports, to resource, to separate classes, schools, home, and hospital, and choose based on individual needs.	Thinking a district may offer only one type of placement for a category.	A placement question where the option the student needs does not exist locally.
6	Keyword mnemonics	The keyword method links a new term to a familiar sound-alike word and an interactive image to boost recall of vocabulary and facts.	Using rote repetition alone for unfamiliar vocabulary.	Students with memory weaknesses must learn new terms.
7	Executive function supports	Students with executive function weaknesses need external supports (checklists, visual timers, broken-down steps) that are taught and then faded.	Treating disorganization as laziness and using consequences alone.	A capable student who misses steps, loses work, or cannot start tasks.
8	Twice-exceptional learners	Students can be gifted and have a disability; strengths can mask the disability and the disability can hide giftedness, so both need to be served.	Thinking a gifted student cannot have a disability, or that serving one need is enough.	Uneven profile: advanced reasoning with a weak skill area.

Course scope (public description): Special Education Curriculum is designed for candidates who plan to teach in a special education program at any grade level from kindergarten through grade 12. This course reviews the basic principles of special education and their application in realistic situations. Its focus is on five major content areas: Development and Characteristics of Learners, Planning and the Learning Environment, Instruction, Assessment, and Foundations and Professional Responsibilities which align to CEC Standards.